

Your Artist's Retreat in Nashville, IN

Here's the pricing landscape and what the research says about making retreats great.

Pricing Landscape

Most domestic art retreats charge **\$750-\$2,000 per person** depending on length and what's included.

The formula: Add up costs · add margin · divide by minimum guest count.

Format	What People Actually Charge		-----	-----		Day workshop (3-4 hrs, no lodging)	\$100-\$300
Weekend (2-3 nights, all-inclusive)	\$775-\$1,400						
Night immersive	\$1,750-\$2,500						

Nashville, IN Advantages

- Established artist colony with built-in cultural credibility
 - Brown County's natural beauty · rolling hills, forests, scenic drives
 - Spring and fall: mild weather, peak leaf season draws visitors
 - Very few structured visual art retreats in the area · open market
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The Formula

Total Costs + Profit Margin = Target Revenue
Target Revenue ÷ Minimum Guest Count = Price Per Person

Always divide by minimum guest count · the fewest you'd run it for. Everyone above that is profit.

What Goes Into Your Costs

Fixed (same whether you have 8 guests or 15):

- Venue / studio rental
- Your fee as facilitator (yes, pay yourself)
- Insurance
- Marketing & admin time

Variable (per guest):

- Lodging
 - Meals
 - Art supplies & materials
 - Welcome kit or gifts
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Key Decisions

- 1 **Price with confidence.** Retreat attendees expect to invest. Underpricing signals low value.
- 2 **Require a deposit.** \$300-\$500, non-refundable. Reduces no-shows dramatically.
- 3 **Offer room tiers.** Shared vs. private is standard. Spread is usually \$400-\$500.

- 4 **Validate first.** 10-15 real conversations with potential attendees before committing.
 - 5 **Buffer 10-15%** something always costs more than expected.
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Additional Revenue Streams

- Premium supply kits at a markup
 - Optional 1-on-1 sessions at a premium rate
 - Nashville/Brown County partnerships (gallery visits, local artisan experiences)
 - Post-retreat digital content or recordings
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What Makes Retreats Great (From Attendee Research)

These patterns come from real attendees, host retrospectives, and community discussions.

1. **Connections matter more than curriculum.** Design for togetherness · shared meals, evening hangouts, collaborative moments. The art instruction matters, but it's not the whole thing.
 2. **Welcome all levels explicitly.** Say it in marketing. Say it on day one. The retreats that get raved about create genuine no-judgment space.
 3. **Balance structure with breathing room.** Clear daily rhythm (morning session, afternoon session) with generous unstructured time.
 4. **Venue atmosphere > amenities.** Natural light, gardens, quiet, beauty. Noise can ruin the experience.
 5. **Keep it small.** 8-16 people. Everyone knows names by day two.
 6. **First hour sets the tone.** Personal greeting. Space ready. Food/drink available immediately.
 7. **Feed people well.** Thoughtful > fancy. Include a few small delights.
 8. **End with momentum.** Closing circle, take-home project, plan for staying connected.
 9. **Your energy sets the room.** Build in margin for yourself too.
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Research drawn from: squadtrip.com, processarts.com, artworkshops.com, theretreatplanner.com, offsiteio.com, art2life.com, outdoorpainter.com, bookretreats.com, selvaradov.net, newsletteroperator.com, reviewedbyartists.com, globalwellnessinstitute.org, grandviewresearch.com